The Payson Morning Scroll

Made Exclusively for the Mogollon's Hearth Guests

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

The Greybeards of High Hrothgar — Publisher & Proprietor

Payson, Arizona · Loredas, the 17th of Frostfall (Saturday, October 17, 2026) ·
Morning Edition — Vol. 2610, No. 17 · Price: One Septim



Gandy keeps dry under the eaves while Maevy bats at the afternoon raindrops.

Skies o'er the Hold

63° / 50°

PM showers

Sunrise 6:32 AM · Sunset 5:48 PM

Tomorrow — AM showers, 63/50

The Moon's Reckoning



Yesterday Waxing Crescent · *Tonight* First Quarter · *Tomorrow*

waxing toward the full moon

17th of Frostfall = October 17

Months run one-for-one all year
Sundas=Sun … Loredas=Sat

Around the Holds · The Week Ahead

Pumpkins, Painters, and Great Drums Fill a Showery Loredas

Payson, Ariz.

Hail, wayfarer, and good Loredas morning — the Rim wakes cool at 50 degrees, the pines stand grey-green under a sky bound for 63 with showers promised by afternoon, so take the morning while it is dry.



Painters, drummers, and pumpkin stalls — Loredas lays out its best before the afternoon showers.

Sedona throws its Fest of Fall at noon with pumpkins splashing in the pool beside it, painters spread their easels for the Plein Air Festival, great taiko drums sound in Prescott, and a caravan of fine cars climbs the Beeline to breakfast in Payson. By the Nine, friend of the Hearth, it is a day to wander early and find a warm hall when the rain comes.

Happening in the Holds Today

- **Payson**

  — Payson Drive 'n Dine to Crosswinds Restaurant — cars leave Mesa at 9 AM and reach Payson before 10:30 AM for breakfast and lunch at Crosswinds, by Payson Airport. The Audi Club of Arizona's mountain run up the Beeline ends where model planes hang from the ceiling and real ones sit outside the windows. The listing invites non-members to take a test drive with the club, and non-Audi cars are welcome too. Watch for the caravan rolling into town mid-morning.

  — Morning Café — Unity of Payson — 9:30 AM–12:30 PM, 110 E Bonita, Payson, and on Zoom every Saturday. A gentle, coffee-hour start to Loredas: good company and an uplifting talk to open the day. It runs every Saturday, so guests can join from the Hearth by Zoom without driving anywhere. Check unityofpayson.org for the blue Zoom link.

- **Camp Verde**

  — Beaver Creek School Reunion — from 9 AM, Beaver Creek School, Beaver Creek School Rd, Rimrock, just south of Camp Verde. A full day of reconnecting and reminiscing for the school's friends and faculty, with a Flag Assembly at 10 AM, an assembly at 11 AM, lunch at noon, and activities into the afternoon. A true small-school homecoming — old classmates, old teachers, and stories from the Beaver Creek valley. The listing asks folks to register ahead of time.

  — The Blue Canyon Band Residency — 8 PM–midnight, Cliff Castle Casino and Hotel, Camp Verde. Two nights of live band music close out the week, and tonight is the second show of the band's weekend residency. Expect a party crowd, dancing energy, and casino-hall entertainment right off I-17. A good after-dinner option once the sun drops behind the red rocks. Guests in the Verde Valley can make an easy night of it.

  — Saturday Starlight Train — Verde Canyon Railroad — 3:30 PM departure, 300 N Broadway, Clarkdale, about 25 minutes from Camp Verde. The popular Starlight run rides four hours through Verde Canyon — daylight first, then sunset colour on the cliff walls, then twilight and starlight under wide skies. Romantic, unhurried, and one of the Verde Valley's signature evenings. These Saturday trips run on select Saturdays through Nov. 21.

- **Sedona**

  — Fest of Fall — 12–6 PM, Posse Grounds Park, 525 Posse Ground Rd, Sedona. The City of Sedona's big fall party packs food trucks, craft and community vendors, a Kids' Zone, a Gaming Center, and a Ride Jam at the skate park into one afternoon, with pickleball and cornhole tournaments and live music all day. It aims to be low- or zero-waste — bring a reusable water bottle for a raffle entry. A free shuttle runs from the West SR 89A Park & Ride.

  — The Great Pumpkin Splash — 11 AM–1 PM, free, Sedona Community Pool, 570 Posse Ground Rd, Sedona. Halloween starts in a swimming pool: families jump in to pick their very own floating pumpkin from the water. After the splash, kids decorate their pumpkin at a no-mess sticker station and take home a goodie bag. Registration secures a pumpkin and a raffle ticket. It ends just as Fest of Fall opens next door, so families can stay all afternoon.

  — Sedona Plein Air Festival — artist demonstrations today — festival runs Oct. 16–24, based at Sedona Arts Center, 15 Art Barn Rd, Sedona; free demo today 10 AM–noon at the Outbound Sedona Hotel, and painter Liam Matthew Dye demonstrates 11 AM–3 PM at Mountain Trails Gallery, Tlaquepaque. Twenty-six artists from across the country paint the red rocks outdoors and in real time for nine days. Watch a canvas catch the very light you are standing in. A perfect pairing with Fest of Fall for an art-filled Loredas.

- **Show Low**

  — Third Annual Autumn Bazaar — 9 AM–2 PM, White Mountain United Methodist Church, 261 N 5th St, Show Low. A proper fall bazaar: handmade crafts from local artisans, a bake sale of sweet treats, and special activities for the kids. Spend a crisp autumn morning browsing while supporting local vendors. All proceeds support the church's projects, including its food pantry and the Thanksgiving Turkey Dinner Drive. Family-friendly and community-run — a Show Low Loredas tradition in the making.

  — Show Low Film Festival — today is a full festival day, WME Village 8, 1501 W White Mountain Blvd, Pinetop-Lakeside; day pass $75, block tickets $15. Independent filmmakers and movie lovers gather in the White Mountains for this eight-years-running festival, with about 100 selected projects. Today's programme adds workshops on screenwriting, music in film, and learning to pitch, alongside film blocks through the day. Sunday closes with a free showcase block.

- **Prescott**

  — Taiko Drumming Workshop and Taiko Extravaganza — workshops 9 AM–1 PM and evening show 7 PM, Elks Performing Arts Center, 117 E Gurley St, Prescott. World-class taiko artist Ken Koshio leads a beginner-friendly, hands-on workshop in ancient Japanese drumming — all drums provided, no experience needed. The day crescendos with the evening Taiko Extravaganza, fusing Japanese drumming and world music with World Hoop Dance Champion Derrick Suwaima Davis. Taiko is heard with the whole body — feel it in your chest.

— OktoberMarket with Holly Ridge — 12–8 PM, The Grand Highland Hotel, 154 S Montezuma St, Prescott. Prescott's fall market season kicks off inside the hotel ballroom and out in its courtyard, with artisan vendors offering organic skincare, baked goods, jewellery, apparel, woodwork, and soaps. There are pumpkins and spooky treats for kids and kids at heart. Come for coffee, stay for lunch, or wander in after dinner — this year they are testing longer hours.

— Free Garden Class: Effortless Plants for Busy Gardeners — 9:30–10:30 AM, 1815 W Iron Springs Rd, Prescott. Want a gorgeous garden without spending every weekend on upkeep? This free morning class dives into low-maintenance plants that actually thrive in the Arizona climate. Expect practical picks and care tips aimed at busy gardeners who would rather relax in their yard than labour in it. Arrive curious; leave with a planting list.

The Days Ahead

- **Sun, Oct. 18**

  — **Howl-O-Ween Dog Costume Parade** — 10 AM–noon, check-in 9–9:30 AM, Tlaquepaque Arts & Shopping Village, Sedona; registration $20, benefiting the Humane Society of Sedona. Costumed canines parade through the courtyards for $100 prizes as Doggone Cutest, Craziest Canine, and Leaders of the Pack, with a 50/50 raffle and swag bags besides. Dress up your dog, yourself, or the whole family. Spectators line the route — pure Sedona charm with wagging tails.

  — **Sedona Community Farmers Market — winter hours** — 11 AM–3 PM, Wells Fargo Bank parking lot, 2201 W State Route 89A, West Sedona. The market settles into its Sunday winter hours with live music and vendors offering pastured chicken, grass-fed beef, artisan bakery goods, fish, honey, eggs, and pot pies. Seasonal produce, specialty foods, and handmade crafts fill out the stalls. Leashed, well-behaved dogs are welcome. A slow Sunday browse under the red rocks.

- **Mon, Oct. 19**

  — **D.A. Ranch Paint Out — Sedona Plein Air Festival** — 4–7 PM, D.A. Ranch, Cornville; $45 per guest, limited tickets. Watch festival artists paint across the ranch grounds from 4–6 PM, among the historic red barn, pastures, ponds, orchards, and vineyards. Awards and an exclusive sale of the works created that very afternoon follow at 6:30 PM. D.A. Ranch wines are for sale, with a grazing table and live music. Golden-hour art, wine, and music in the Verde Valley.

- **Tue, Oct. 20**

  — **Trail Day Volunteer Build** — 7 AM–noon, on Hwy 87 just before Pine, with PINE Strawberry Fuel Reduction. "Don't just use the trail — help build it": volunteers clear brush, move rocks, break roots, and shape a trail the community will use for years. The work also creates better access routes for firefighters and emergency crews. Tools are provided; bring water, sunscreen, gloves if you have them, and sturdy shoes. Email trails@psfuelreduction.org for directions.

- **Wed, Oct. 21**

  — **Long-Term Water Management Plan Community Meeting** — 1–3 PM, Prescott Public Library, 215 E Goodwin St, Prescott. City staff open with a 45-minute presentation on Prescott's water supplies, current and future needs, and strategies for conservation and efficiency. Information stations follow, where residents can talk one-to-one with City representatives and take a community survey. Can't attend? The survey is online, and your input still feeds the plan's first draft. Dry-country homework that truly matters.

  — **Paint Out at a Private Sedona Residence** — 4–7 PM, private Sedona residence, address with ticket; $60 per guest, limited tickets. The Plein Air Festival's most intimate evening: a small audience watches artists paint from 4–6 PM amid sweeping red-rock views. Awards and an exclusive sale of the afternoon's works begin at 6:30 PM. Wine, beer, and Southwest BBQ are served as the sun sets. Part art show, part garden party, part treasure hunt.

- **Thu, Oct. 22**
  — **Camp Carpe Diem Verde Valley 2026 opens** — Oct. 22–25, basecamp at Verde River RV Resort & Cottages, Camp Verde; ticketed. A grown-up camp and "UnRally" for RVers, van-lifers, tent campers, and travellers: four days exploring the valley's hiking, biking, breweries, wineries, and ghost towns. Organisers handle the details; campers pick how much or how little to do, with community dinners along the way. This year's edition lands at peak fall colour. Come for the adventure; stay for the company.

- **Fri, Oct. 23**
  — **Paint & Sip "Three Ghosts"** — 6 PM, 100 N White Mountain Rd, Ste 101, Show Low. A Halloween-week paint night: settle in with a brush and a sip to create "Three Ghosts," a seasonal canvas to take home. The listing points painters to Kittles Fine Art for full information and registration under "Upcoming Classes." A relaxed Fredas-evening way to start the last weekend before Halloween. The ghosts, we are assured, are friendly ones.

QUESTS OF THE HEARTH

Quests awaiting:



The Hearth shield on the workbench, with the torch sconces lined up beside it.

- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Overdue since Sept. 26 — draw the sconces and ready them before a single torch can burn.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Overdue since Oct. 3 — the printers stand ready; give them their orders.
- ☐ **Finish & install the torches** — Overdue since Oct. 10 — hang the finished torches and light the way.
- ☐ **Build the Mogollon's Hearth shield** — Due today, Saturday, Oct. 17 — the Hearth's arms take shape at last.
- ☐ **Mount the shield by the front door** — Due Oct. 24 — hang it on a French cleat where every guest can see it.
- ☐ **Doors — Mogollon Hearth** — Due Oct. 24 — the Hearth's doors are next on the quest board.

The shield is due today, Saturday, Oct. 17 — and the torches still wait overdue, wanting their sconces printed and hung.

Merchant of the Hold

Oak Creek Brewing Company · *Sedona*



The brewers of Oak Creek at their kettle, tankards raised in the garden beyond.

Sedona's own working craft brewery and brewpub, handcrafting brews for more than 30 years right where you drink them — Sedona's oldest craft brewery, pouring since 1995. The signature pour is the Nut Brown Ale — rich, nutty, with a hint of spice — with the Hefeweizen close behind, and Zen Dough's inside turns out fresh pizza, pretzels, and cod fish and chips to go with your pint in the outdoor beer garden. Some small kindly enchantment keeps every tankard cool and every crust crisp, or so the regulars swear.

> *"Great chill atmosphere! The beer is really good."* — Google review

2050 Yavapai Dr, Sedona, AZ 86336 · Sat noon–10 PM, Fri noon–10 PM, Mon/Wed/Thu 2–8 PM, Tue 2–11 PM (karaoke 8–11 PM), Sun noon–8 PM · 928-204-1300 · $ (easy on the purse) · Good to know: live music Fri–Sat nights and Hoppy Hour daily 4–7 PM; dogs are not permitted, and the Tlaquepaque Grill with the same beers is a different place — head for Yavapai Drive for the brewery itself. · their scrying-mirror page (other travelers call it a 'website')

Why the Hearth sends you: A true mead-hall in spirit — beer brewed on the spot, bards playing on the weekend, and a garden to sit in after a day on the red-rock trails.

Tales from the Treeline

The First Pinecone Bowling Championship



The championship roll — ten pins, one splash.

Loredas stayed dry all morning, and Jethro (the Mogollon Monster) declared the Hearth clearing open for the First Pinecone Bowling Championship. The pins were ten proud acorns in a row. The ball was the roundest pinecone in the forest. Henny (the Hearth's chicken) kept score by clucking once for every pin down, which made her the busiest official in the Hold.

Earl (an elk) rolled first, with great dignity and no aim at all — his pinecone veered into Mabel's herb basket and he declared it a practice throw. Then Flurry (a young ice-breathing dragon) breathed one careful ribbon of ice-mist down the lane to make it properly slick, and Jethro took his run-up just as the afternoon showers arrived.

That dang ol' Jethro hit the slick lane at full trot, slid past the acorns, past Henny, and clean into the rain barrel, taking all ten pins down with the splash. Henny clucked ten times without stopping. The championship trophy — a shiny bottle cap from Flurry's hoard — is still in the barrel, and Jethro says that is exactly where champions keep them.

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Loredas be free of bears, Clay.

Ask the Hearth ✉

…or write to us straight: mogollonshearth@gmail.com